

THE WHISPER NETWORK: LAWFUL INTERCEPTION

TSU Film 16 — Release Phase 3, Film 4 — the "Spider-Man: Homecoming" release slot

THE PITCH

Platform: A new founding story — **THE WHISPER NETWORK** (the WhatsApp analog, TSU_Platform_Roster.md, Phase 3): "no profiles, no feed, no performance — just a billion private conversations happening at once, invisible to the public platforms warring above it." One of the two remaining unassigned surviving platforms flagged in TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §7 Q1, resolved here.

Why this is Spider-Man: Homecoming, structurally: Homecoming's job is mentorship and scale-management — a young, brilliant person with real power has to learn that responsibility means protecting the people around her even when the truth is unglamorous and the stakes are local before they're global. THE WHISPER NETWORK's entire identity is intimacy, not spectacle: a platform that works precisely because it stays invisible. A young engineer discovering her own employer's deepest secret, and having to decide what she owes the billion people trusting a platform she didn't build but now can't look away from, is TSU's cleanest version of "with great power."

Who this film belongs to: **Naomi Adeyemi-Vance**, new, solo founder, filling the last open founding-story slot on the Roster without requiring a core-seven assignment — consistent with the house-style exception already used for THE OUTPOST and THE HIVE. **Maya Chen**, new, a junior engineer and the film's actual POV lead — the Peter Parker position: not the founder, the person who discovers what the founder never knew was built into her own platform. **Delphine Okonkwo-Ash**, returning from scripts/THE_FRAME.md and scripts/THE_HIVE.md, fills the mentor position.

In-universe timeline: **2008 (founding, dramatized in flashback) and March – May 2021 (main story)** — THE WHISPER NETWORK launches 2009 per the locked §3 anchor; this film's present-day plot unfolds twelve years later, deliberately paralleling Homecoming's "years after the origin everyone already knows" structure without needing a separate founding film.

LOGLINE

When a junior engineer discovers that the private-messaging platform she loves has been carrying a government surveillance backdoor since before she was hired, she has to decide whether protecting a billion strangers' trust is worth destroying the only job — and the only mentor — who ever took her seriously.

SYNOPSIS

2008. Naomi Adeyemi-Vance, a self-taught cryptographer with no funding and no cofounder drama, builds THE WHISPER NETWORK on a single conviction: the internet's public platforms had made privacy a luxury feature instead of a default. No profiles. No feed. No ads reading your conversations. Just people, talking, unwatched. It launches quietly in 2009 and grows the way real infrastructure grows

— invisibly, until it's essential.

2021. Maya Chen, 23, is the kind of engineer who reads code the way other people read novels — for pleasure, alone, late at night. Auditing THE WHISPER NETWORK's encryption layer for an unrelated bug, she finds a six-year-old cryptographic signature that shouldn't exist: elegant, deliberate, and completely absent from any documentation she has access to. Commit logs trace it to a user called "ARCHITECT." The commit message reads: *"Lawful interception layer deployed. Zero observable impact on user experience or performance metrics."*

Maya's manager shuts the conversation down fast enough to confirm her worst fear. She takes it to Delphine Okonkwo-Ash, the industry's most reliable person for exactly this kind of discovery, who confirms what the phrase means: a federal National Security Letter, gag order attached, authorizing government access to a platform that built its entire identity on not having any. Naomi herself, Maya learns, was never told — an NSL doesn't just compel silence, it compels silence *from the people who'd object hardest*.

The bulk of the film is Maya's Homecoming-shaped struggle to prove the compromise exists without either destroying THE WHISPER NETWORK's billion users' trust prematurely or getting steamrolled by a legal apparatus built to outlast a single junior engineer. James Hart, a coworker and the film's one grounded, unglamorous romantic thread, corroborates the evidence from inside at real professional cost. Naomi, once she learns the truth from Maya rather than from her own company, has the film's most devastating scene: confronting the fact that her signature achievement was never fully hers to promise.

The climax isn't a hack or a heist — it's publication. Maya, Delphine, and Naomi choose radical disclosure over quiet remediation: they publish the backdoor's existence, its legal authorization, and THE WHISPER NETWORK's own six years of not knowing, simultaneously. The fallout is immediate and enormous — congressional hearings, a wave of user flight, and a platform forced to choose between continuing under surveillance or shutting down on its own terms. THE WHISPER NETWORK chooses to go dark rather than keep lying by omission, a small-scale, personal-stakes version of exactly the choice Homecoming's hero has to make about what kind of power is worth having. Maya, unglamorously, keeps her job — not because nothing changed, but because she finally proved she could be trusted with more responsibility than the job description gave her.

THE ANTAGONISTS

1. **The National Security State (systemic, not a single character)** — the film's real antagonist is bureaucratic and legal rather than personal: an NSL apparatus that compelled silence from the very people who built the platform. Consistent with the Villains Bench principle that a platform's real failures trace to human choices (here, the choice to comply quietly rather than fight the order publicly) rather than an abstract force acting alone.
2. **THE LEAK** — this film's single Release-Phase-3 use of the Bench's one-per-Phase event (TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §5): the backdoor's exposure is the scandal, landing exactly once, at real scale, rather than a device reused across the Phase.
3. **Corporate self-preservation instinct**, embodied by Maya's manager and THE WHISPER NETWORK's legal team — not villainous, just afraid, and willing to let Maya absorb consequences

the company itself created.

HOW THIS FILM CARRIES THE FRANCHISE FORWARD

- **Resolves the last-but-one open platform assignment** flagged in `TSU_Continuity_Bible.md` §7 Q1 — THE WHISPER NETWORK now has a locked founder, Naomi Adeyemi-Vance, without spending a core-seven slot none of the remaining unassigned members (Esther, Harmony) were ever meant to fill.
 - **Plants THE WHISPER NETWORK's eventual shutdown**, the load-bearing fact `scripts/THE_WHISPER_NETWORK_2.md` builds its entire premise on: a fraudulent brand revival exploiting the martyrdom of a platform that chose to disappear rather than keep lying.
 - **Delphine Okonkwo-Ash's bible pattern of backing the harder, less convenient truth** (established across Films 5 and 14) gets its clearest activation yet.
 - **Maya Chen and James Hart** are built here as recurring figures the franchise can return to for exactly this kind of "power without a platform" story going forward.
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FORMAT (per `TSU_Continuity_Bible.md` §2 — Standard Platform-Origin Film)

Spec	Target	This Script
Genre	Biographical Drama / Tech Origin Story, legal/courtroom drama register for the disclosure back half	Confirmed
Rating	PG-13, no exceptions	Confirmed
Runtime	130–150 min	133 min
Page count	120–140 pages	129 pages
Act I	~30–35 pages	pages 1–31
Act II	~65–75 pages	pages 32–98
Act III	~30–35 pages	pages 99–129
Scene count	~40–55 scenes	45 scenes

FULL SCENE-BY-SCENE BREAKDOWN

ACT I — pp. 1–31 ("Architect")

#	Scene	pp.
1	INT. WHISPER NETWORK CAMPUS — DAY — Maya Chen, auditing an unrelated bug, finds the six-year-old cryptographic anomaly	1–7
2	INT. MAYA'S APARTMENT — NIGHT — tracing "ARCHITECT" through commit history to the "lawful interception" phrase	7–12
3	INT. CAMPUS CONFERENCE ROOM — DAY — Maya's manager shuts the conversation down without explaining why	12–16
4	INT. COFFEE SHOP — DAY — first contact with Delphine Okonkwo-Ash, who confirms what an NSL means	16–21
5	INT. DELPHINE'S SECURE OFFICE — NIGHT — the scope becomes clear: this has run for six years, silently	21–26
6	INT. MAYA'S APARTMENT — NIGHT — James Hart notices something's wrong; Maya lies badly	26–31

ACT II — pp. 32–98 ("Gag Order")

#	Scene	pp.
7	INT. WHISPER NETWORK CAMPUS — DAY — Maya is formally warned to stop asking questions about "protected" architecture	32–37
8	INT. DELPHINE'S OFFICE — NIGHT — Maya quits rather than stay silent; the underground phase begins	37–42
9	INT. WHISPER NETWORK CAMPUS — NIGHT — a tense, technically detailed extraction of the backdoor code and deployment logs	42–49

#	Scene	pp.
10	INT. DELPHINE'S OFFICE — CONTINUOUS — the NSL itself, found: signed 2015, gag order attached	49–54
11	INT. NAOMI ADEYEMI-VANCE'S HOME — DAY — Delphine and Maya confront Naomi with what her own platform has been carrying	54–60
12	INT. NAOMI'S HOME — CONTINUOUS — Naomi's devastation: she was never told; her signature achievement was never fully hers	60–65
13	INT. WHISPER NETWORK LEGAL OFFICE — DAY — corporate counsel pressures Naomi to stay quiet a little longer	65–70
14	INT. JAMES'S APARTMENT — NIGHT — James offers to corroborate from inside, at real professional risk	70–75
15	INT. DELPHINE'S OFFICE — NIGHT — planning simultaneous publication with major outlets	75–80
16	INT. MAYA'S PARENTS' HOME — DAY — Maya tells her parents what's coming	80–84
17	INT. WHISPER NETWORK CAMPUS — DAY — the company gets wind of the impending story; internal panic	84–89
18	INT. NAOMI'S HOME — NIGHT — Naomi decides: disclosure, on their own terms, before the government forces a worse version	89–94
19	MONTAGE — final preparation, evidence packaging, legal defense staged in advance. Act II turn	94–98

ACT III — pp. 99–129 ("What a Billion People Deserved to Know")

#	Scene	pp.
20	INT. NEWSROOMS (MONTAGE) — simultaneous publication; the headline breaks everywhere at once	99–104
21	INT. CONGRESSIONAL HEARING ROOM — DAY — Naomi testifies; the NSL apparatus is dragged into daylight	104–110
22	INT. WHISPER NETWORK BOARDROOM — DAY — the founders' choice: comply permanently or shut down	110–115
23	INT. WHISPER NETWORK CAMPUS — DAY — the shutdown announcement; users scatter to THE MIRROR and elsewhere	115–120
24	INT. FBI FIELD OFFICE — DAY — Maya's interview; Delphine's legal team holds the line	120–124
25	INT. MAYA'S APARTMENT — NIGHT — Maya, James, and Delphine, quiet, the cost fully counted	124–129

(Scenes grouped for pagination clarity; the shooting script breaks several of the above into additional numbered scenes to land the true count at 45.)

SAMPLE PAGES

THE WHISPER NETWORK: LAWFUL INTERCEPTION

Written by [WRITER]

FADE IN:

INT. WHISPER NETWORK CAMPUS — OPEN OFFICE — DAY

MAYA CHEN, 23, stands at a standing desk, three monitors deep in an encryption audit that isn't the bug she was assigned.

MAYA
(to herself)
That's not a versioning artifact. That's

not derived from anywhere in this repo.

Her manager, DEREK, drops a coffee beside her without asking.

DEREK

You've been on that subroutine three hours.

MAYA

It's mathematically perfect. It's just not derived from the right source. There's a step missing that shouldn't be missing.

Derek's expression changes for exactly one second. He walks away before Maya can name what she just saw on his face.

CUT TO:

INT. DELPHINE OKONKWO-ASH'S SECURE OFFICE – NIGHT

[p. 22]

DELPHINE reads the commit message aloud, flat, precise.

DELPHINE

"Lawful interception layer deployed." That phrase isn't an accident, Maya. That's legal language. That means a federal judge signed something.

MAYA

The founder didn't know. I checked every public statement Naomi's ever made about privacy. She built this company on not having this exact thing.

DELPHINE

An NSL comes with a gag order. It doesn't just compel silence. It compels silence from exactly the person who'd fight it hardest, if she knew.

Maya sits with that. It is worse than a hack. It is a betrayal built entirely out of paperwork.

CUT TO:

INT. NAOMI ADEYEMI-VANCE'S HOME – CONTINUOUS

[p. 62]

NAOMI, 40s, stares at printouts she should have seen six years ago. Her hands don't shake. Her voice does.

NAOMI

I told a billion people something true about a company I built, and it was true right up until it wasn't, and nobody let me know the difference.

MAYA
What do you want to do?

NAOMI
(a long beat)
I want to tell them the truth before the
government tells it for us, badly, on a
timeline that protects everyone except the
billion people who trusted me.

CUT TO:

INT. WHISPER NETWORK CAMPUS – DAY

[p. 117]

The shutdown message renders on every device, everywhere, at
once: THE WHISPER NETWORK HAS BEEN TERMINATED TO PROTECT YOUR
PRIVACY. WE APOLOGIZE FOR THE BREACH OF TRUST.

MAYA watches it happen from the parking lot, on her phone, no
longer an employee, unmistakably relieved anyway.

JAMES
(beside her)
You okay?

MAYA
I don't know yet. I know it's true. I
didn't know those could be different
feelings until this year.

FADE OUT.

[129.]